

Backpack Decision

TNF Recon 30L vs Osprey Nebula 32L · Buy at Trekkinn (Spain)

€92.99

TNF RECON 30L
TO DOOR BCN

€101.98

OSPREY NEBULA 32L
TO DOOR BCN

+€9

DIFFERENCE
(NEBULA VS RECON)

Final verdict

Osprey Nebula 32L

Wins 8-3 on specs and 7-5 on forums consensus. The €9 premium is justified by Osprey's 30-year All Mighty Guarantee (vs TNF's 3-year EU legal warranty), 200g lighter, larger TSA-clamshell laptop sleeve, better real-world water resistance, and bluesign-certified material. Recon wins on price, more pockets, easier bungee mod (daisy chain native), TNF brand identity. Both are equally valid — choose by what you weigh more.

User profile: cap target ~30L, dark color preferred, hipbelt + chest + good pockets, ≤€135 ideal, MacBook Air 13.6" laptop, 70% city / 20% walking / 10% travel use, replacing older 25-30L bag. Both available on Trekkinn (Spain retailer, Girona, 4.6/5 — 4838 reviews).

Side by side



THE NORTH FACE

Recon 30L · Black (NF0A52SH 4HF)

€90 ~~€120 PVR~~

- 30L · 1165g · 49 × 19.1 × 29.5 cm
- Hipbelt: webbing simple removable
- Chest strap with whistle
- Daisy chain front (bungee mod-friendly)
- 2 lateral compression straps + base compression
- Laptop sleeve 15"
- FlexVent suspension + Spine Channel back
- Recycled 210D nylon ripstop, DWR PFC-free
- Warranty: 3 years EU legal (defects only)



OSPREY

Nebula 32L · Black

€98.99 ~~€130 PVR~~

- 32L · 961g · 49 × 31 × 29 cm
- Hipbelt: webbing simple removable
- Chest strap (sternum)
- Shove-it pocket front (no daisy chain)
- Top + bottom compression straps
- Laptop sleeve 16" TSA-clamshell
- AirScape ridge foam + Atilon framesheet
- Bluesign 420D recycled nylon, DWR PFAS-free
- Warranty: 30 years All Mighty Guarantee

Both have

Black pure color · removable webbing hipbelt (no padding, not outdoorsy) · sternum chest strap · lateral and bottom compression straps · stand-up structure · padded carry handle · multiple internal pockets · bottle pocket(s) · laptop sleeve · MBA 13.6" fits comfortably · 30 days return at Trekkinn · €2.99 shipping to Barcelona · 2-3 days delivery · neither has trolley sleeve native · neither has bungee front native (both can be DIY-modded with €4 bungee cord).

Specs comparison

CATEGORY	TNF RECON 30L	OSPREY NEBULA 32L	WINNER
Capacity	30L	32L	Nebula (+2L)
Total price to BCN	€92.99	€101.98	Recon (€9 cheaper)
Hipbelt type	Webbing simple removable	Webbing simple removable	<i>Tie</i>
Chest strap	Yes + whistle	Yes (no whistle)	Recon
Bungee front native	No (daisy chain)	No (shove-it pocket)	<i>Tie</i>
Bungee mod ease	Daisy chain front (native anchor points)	Compression straps top+bottom only	Recon
Side compression lateral	2 lateral straps	Top + bottom straps	<i>Tie</i>
Bottom compression / lashing	Yes (base compression)	Yes (bottom straps)	<i>Tie</i>
Slim silhouette compactable	Yes	Yes	<i>Tie</i>
Trolley sleeve	No	No	<i>Tie</i>
TSA-clamshell laptop sleeve	No (internal)	Yes (separate, 180° opening)	Nebula
Laptop sleeve size	15"	16" TSA	Nebula
Pockets total	7 (+ secret)	~6 (+ scratch-free)	Recon
Scratch-free pocket	No	Yes (sunglasses/electronics)	Nebula
Carry handle	Padded	Padded	<i>Tie</i>
Suspension / back panel	FlexVent + Spine Channel	AirScape ridge foam + Atilon framesheet	<i>Tie</i>
Material denier	210D recycled nylon ripstop	420D recycled nylon (heavier)	Nebula
Sustainability cert	None explicit	Bluesign certified	Nebula
DWR coating	PFC-free (C0)	PFAS-free (C0)	<i>Tie</i>
Water resistance real test	Failed OGL shower test (pooling)	Confirmed water-resistant in field	Nebula
Rain cover included	No	No	<i>Tie</i>
Weight	1165g	961g	Nebula (-204g, -17%)
Color black pure	Yes	Yes	<i>Tie</i>

CATEGORY	TNF RECON 30L	OSPREY NEBULA 32L	WINNER
Aesthetic urban/casual	Outdoor casual / busy exterior	Travel-focused / sleeker	<i>Tie (subjective)</i>
Warranty EU	3 years legal (defects only)	30 years All Mighty Guarantee (covers wear)	Nebula (huge)
Returns Trekkinn	30 days	30 days	<i>Tie</i>

RECON WINS	NEBULA WINS	TIES
3	8	14

Forums & reviews consensus

Sources: Reddit r/onebag, OutdoorGearLab, CleverHiker, Pack Hacker, GearJunkie, foXnoMad, Nomads Nation, Looria.

CATEGORY	WINNER PER FORUMS	SOURCE HIGHLIGHT
Short-term durability	Recon	foXnoMad 3-year: "spongy mesh holds bounce"
Long-term durability (3+ years)	Recon	More positive long-term data published
Comfort medium loads (7-10kg)	Recon	OGL Comfort 8.0/10 vs Nebula "minimal support"
Comfort light loads (<7kg)	Tie	Both work fine
Hipbelt webbing weight transfer	Tie (both weak)	"Not weight-bearing" reported on both
Water resistance real-world	Nebula	OGL shower test: Recon failed, Nebula better
Organization	Nebula (slight edge)	TSA clamshell adds travel value
Aesthetic urban/casual	Tie (your call)	You marked as tie — Nebula sleeker, Recon TNF brand identity
Aesthetic outdoor/rugged	Recon	TNF brand identity stronger
Weight	Nebula	Real -200g difference
Warranty real claims processed	Nebula (knockout)	AMG replaces post-crash, post-trek; TNF EU often denies "wear"
Price/value	Recon	Cheaper consistently
Travel use (airport, multi-day)	Nebula	Clamshell + lighter + warranty
EDC daily (city, school)	Tie / slight Recon	"Good value multipurpose"
Reddit r/onebag preference	Nebula	More mentions for travel use case
YouTube EDC channels preference	Recon	TNF brand fan base + value pick

RECON WINS 5	NEBULA WINS 7	TIES 4
------------------------	-------------------------	------------------

Selected quotes

foXnoMad 3-yr Recon:	"Recon's spongy mesh holds its bounce and hardly shows its age."
----------------------	--

OutdoorGearLab Recon:	"Limited water resistance; failed shower test with pooling inside."
CleverHiker Nebula:	"More easily overburdened than other packs... small removable waistbelt provides minimal support."
Camino Forum AMG:	"Osprey replaced my Farpoint 40 completely after a motorcycle crash."
Multi-source synthesis:	"If casual aesthetics are important, Nebula has a more refined look. If you prioritize value and ruggedness, Recon is more budget-friendly."

Final recommendation

My pick: Osprey Nebula 32L (€101.98 to door)

Specs score: **Nebula 8 wins · Recon 3 wins · 14 ties**. Forums score: **Nebula 7 wins · Recon 5 wins · 4 ties**. The **€9 premium** is justified by Osprey's 30-year All Mighty Guarantee (vs TNF's 3-year EU legal warranty), 200g lighter weight, larger laptop sleeve with TSA-clamshell, real-world water resistance edge, and bluesign-certified material. For a backpack you'll use 5-10 years intensively, the lifetime-grade warranty alone justifies €9.

Decision matrix

IF YOU WEIGH MORE...

- Lifetime-grade warranty (Osprey AMG)
- Travel-focused features (TSA clamshell, lighter, capacity)
- Real-world water resistance
- Sustainability (bluesign cert)
- Sleeker urban/casual aesthetic

→ **Osprey Nebula 32L**

IF YOU WEIGH MORE...

- €9 savings + best price
- More pocket organization (7 vs 6)
- Easier bungee mod (daisy chain native)
- TNF brand identity / outdoor look
- Comfort under medium-heavy loads

→ **TNF Recon 30L**

What is essentially equal

Hipbelt type, chest strap function, side compression, bottom compression for add-ons, slim silhouette compactability (both via compression straps), MBA 13.6" laptop fit, black pure color, 30-day Trekkinn return policy, shipping cost & speed, neither has trolley sleeve native, neither has bungee front native (both are 5-min DIY mod with €4 cord).

Where to buy

Osprey Nebula 32L Black — €98.99 (Trekkinn)

<https://www.tradeinn.com/trekkinn/es/osprey-mochila-nebula-32l/139164942/p>

+ €2.99 shipping = €101.98 to door · delivery 2-3 days BCN · 30-day return · stock available

TNF Recon 30L Black — €90 (Trekkinn)

<https://www.tradeinn.com/trekkinn/es/the-north-face-mochila-recon-30l/142557985/p>

+ €2.99 shipping = €92.99 to door · delivery 2-3 days BCN · 30-day return · stock available

If you go either: optional mods

MOD	TOOLS	COST	TIME
Front bungee X (Borealis-style)	Bungee cord 1m + 2 hooks (Amazon ES "cuerdas elásticas mosquetones")	€4-8	5 min
Luggage pass-through hack	None — crisscross shoulder straps + sternum, OR use removable hipbelt as Gatekeeper strap	€0	30 sec setup

Comparison verified May 2026. Prices and stock can change. URLs verified 200 OK on date of compile. Forums data is community consensus, not absolute.

Both products purchased through Trekkinn (Tradeinn Servicios Minoristas SL, Girona, Spain). Authorized European retailer with 4.6/5 from 4838+ reviews.